



A WORDS HAVE WEATHER STORY EBOOK

Leo and the Cup That Slipped

A spill is something to solve, not someone to blame



THE HOOK

Before the tower

The water hit the floor before Leo's cardboard tower did. It raced under the table and around Ms Chen's shoe.



THE PRESSURE LINE

Careful?

"Careful! You never watch what you're doing," Ms Chen said. Leo's hands stopped in the air.



POSSIBLE WORD-WEATHER

A chilly drizzle

A cold blue drizzle appeared around Leo. Willo tilted one leaf ear. "He may hear that accidents are who he is," Willo said.



KEEP SAFETY

Feet first

Ms Chen held one hand up so the class stayed clear of the slippery patch. Safety still mattered. So did the way back.



REPAIR

Name what happened

"I made that sound like you were the problem. The cup spilled and the floor is slippery. Cloth or paper towel - which will you use?"



A WAY BACK

The cloth

Leo watched the puddle for a moment. Then he chose the cloth. Ms Chen took the other corner. They pushed the water into one small shining line.



CARRY IT FORWARD

Still building

Leo's tower leaned. His cheeks were still warm. But his hands started again - one careful cardboard piece at a time.



READ IT AGAIN

Accident or identity?

"The cup spilled" names an event.
"You never watch" makes a story about Leo. Specific words leave more room for safety, learning and repair.



TRY IT TOGETHER

Spill rehearsal

Tip an empty cup on purpose. Practise three steps: stop feet, name the spill, choose a clean-up tool. Keep the game light and never use a real mistake as a public lesson.



WILLO WONDERS

What could Ms Chen keep?

Ms Chen did not have to pretend the floor was safe. She kept the safety boundary and changed the part that labelled Leo.

Adult notes

Key message: describe the event, protect safety and make repair possible without shame. Try: (1) sort phrases into event words and identity labels; (2) role-play stop-name-choose; (3) invite children to draw what responsibility can look like after an accident. For ages 4-5, keep to one instruction at a time. Do not require an apology before safety is restored.

